Hostel Life Expenses Report

Period: 1 Jan 2025 - 31 Mar 2025 | Prepared by Kajal Rajbhar

Total Expense	Average / Entry	Highest Entry	Lowest Entry
Rs 10,262	**Rs 54.30**	**Rs 130**	**Rs 15**

1. Executive Summary

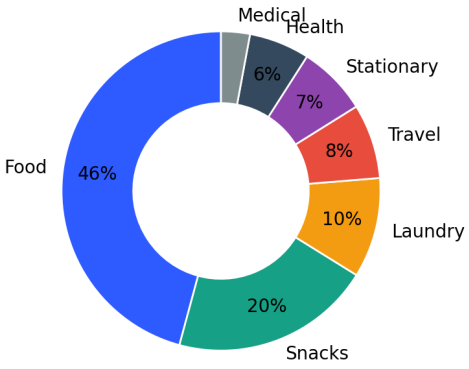
Over the three months from January to March 2025, **189 expense entries** were recorded across **90 days**, totalling **Rs 10,262** (average Rs 54 per entry, about Rs 114 per day). **Food (46%)** and **Snacks (20%)** together account for roughly **66%** of all spending. **UPI** is the main payment mode, covering 76% of the amount.

2. Key Insights

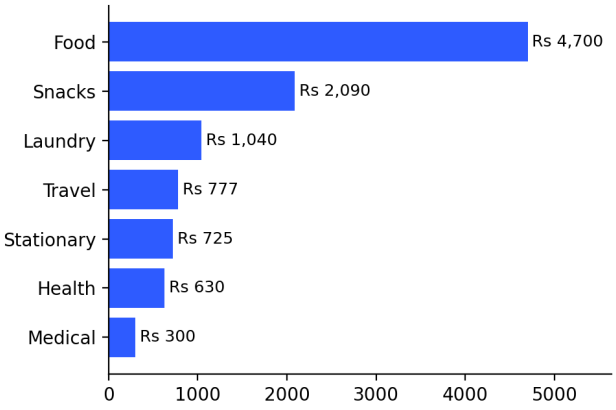
- **Food is the biggest cost:** Rs 4,700 over 47 entries (avg Rs 100 each). All five highest single expenses are Food items (top: Rs 130, "Special lunch" on 6 Jan).
- **Snacks are frequent but small:** 60 entries, the most of any category, at about Rs 35 each. Together they add up to Rs 2,090.
- **Laundry** costs Rs 1,040 (10%), more than Travel (Rs 777) even though it has fewer entries.
- **Health and Medical** together came to Rs 930 across 11 entries (mostly tablets and syrups).
- **Payment mode:** UPI = Rs 7,845 (120 entries); Cash = Rs 2,417 (69 entries). Almost all Food (97%), Health and Medical spending is on UPI, while Laundry, Travel and Stationary are mostly paid in cash.
- **Busiest spending day:** 16 Feb 2025 with Rs 230 in a single day. Daily spend averaged Rs 114, median Rs 118.

3. Spending by Expense Type

Share of spending by expense type



Total spend by expense type (Rs)

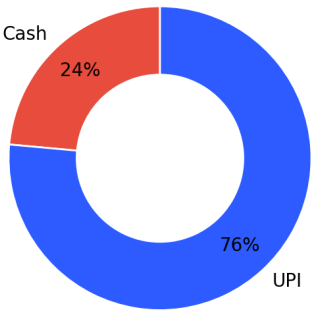


Expense Type	Total (Rs)	Share	Entries	Avg (Rs)
Food	4,700	45.8%	47	100.0
Snacks	2,090	20.4%	60	34.8
Laundry	1,040	10.1%	16	65.0
Travel	777	7.6%	34	22.9
Stationary	725	7.1%	21	34.5
Health	630	6.1%	8	78.8
Medical	300	2.9%	3	100.0
Total	**10,262**	**100%**	**189**	**54.3**

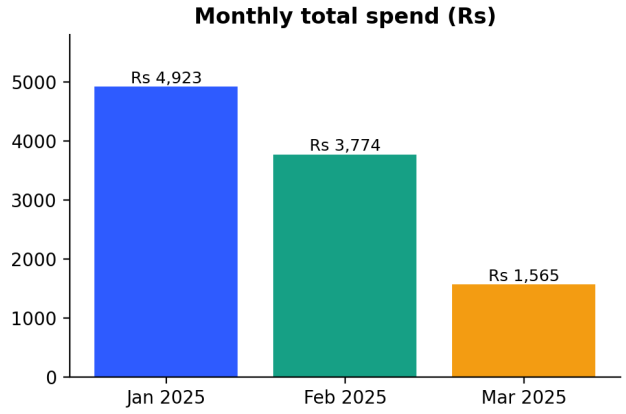
4. Payment Mode Analysis

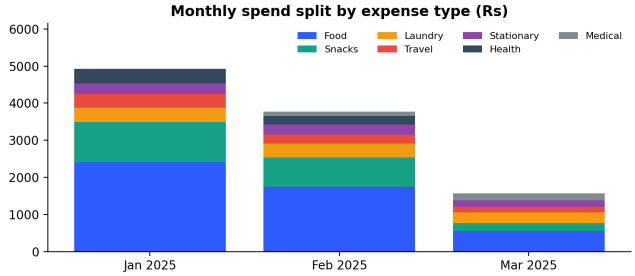
Expense Type	Cash (Rs)	UPI (Rs)
Food	135	4,565
Snacks	485	1,605
Laundry	790	250
Travel	512	265
Stationary	495	230
Health	0	630
Medical	0	300
Total	**2,417**	**7,845**

Payment mode share (by amount)



5. Monthly Trend





Month	Total (Rs)	Entries	Avg / entry (Rs)
Jan 2025	4,923	90	54.7
Feb 2025	3,774	68	55.5
Mar 2025	1,565	31	50.5

Spending falls sharply from Rs 4,923 in January to Rs 3,774 in February and Rs 1,565 in March. **Note:** the number of recorded entries also drops (90, 68, 31), while the average per entry stays steady (about Rs 50-55). This suggests the fall is mostly because fewer expenses were logged in Feb and March, not necessarily that spending actually fell by that much. Monthly totals should therefore be compared with care.

6. Recommendations

- **Set a monthly Food budget.** Food is 46% of spending. Cooking or using the hostel mess more often, and cutting outside meals (e.g. weekend and "mess closed" days), is the biggest saving opportunity.
- **Watch small snack purchases.** Rs 25-55 a time looks small, but 60 entries add up to about Rs 2,090 (20%). A weekly snack limit would help.
- **Keep logging every day.** Entries dropped sharply in March, which makes trend analysis unreliable. Daily logging will give a true picture.
- **Review laundry cost.** Rs 1,040 on laundry is higher than travel. Check whether bulk washing or fewer wash cycles can reduce it.
- **Track Health vs Medical separately or merge them.** Both categories hold similar items (tablets, syrups), so merging them would make the data cleaner.

7. Data Notes

Source: hostel_life_expense_tracker.csv (189 rows, columns: Date, Expense_Type, Amount, Payment_Mode, Notes). No missing values. 1 fully duplicated row was found (same date, type, amount, mode and note); it has been kept in the totals as it may be a genuine repeat purchase. Amounts are in Indian Rupees (Rs).